



THE RENAISSANCE

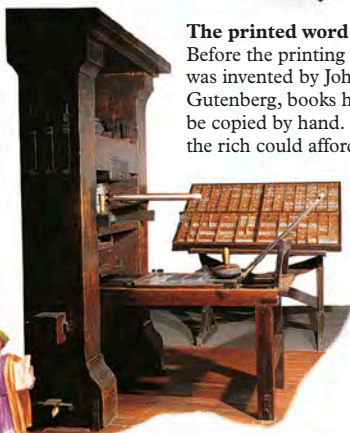
In the 15th century, Europe was bursting with new ideas about art, learning, and religion. Many of the people who could read and write began to ask questions, and to do experiments for themselves rather than follow what their rulers and priests told them to think. They rediscovered many of the ideas that the Greeks and Romans had about life and the world. As a result this period became known as the “Renaissance,” a French word meaning rebirth. The Renaissance started in the cities of northern and central Italy but gradually spread all over Europe.

A letter of type used in the printing press



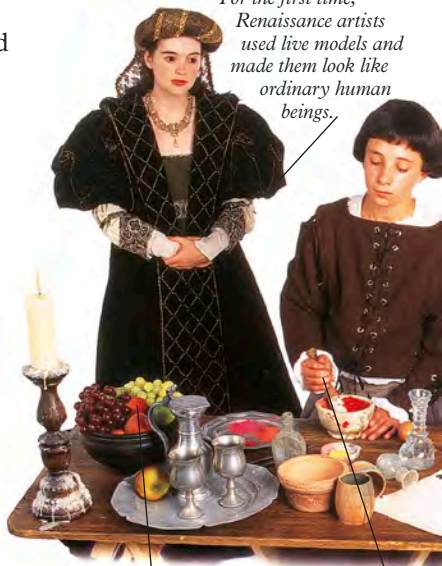
The printed word

Before the printing press was invented by Johannes Gutenberg, books had to be copied by hand. Only the rich could afford them.



Before the Renaissance, most paintings showed mythical scenes or Bible characters, and everything in them looked perfect.

For the first time, Renaissance artists used live models and made them look like ordinary human beings.



Artists began to make realistic paintings of everyday objects.

The apprentice is grinding colors to make paints for his master. He will mix the powder with oil to produce oil paints.

The Gutenberg Bible

These pages come from one of the three books that made up the Gutenberg Bible. It was printed in the 1450s and was admired for its quality.

